B2 - Written Mediation 1: Teacher's Notes

Gender-inclusive language



Before starting the mediation activity, ask students to read the task and the infographic carefully to make the aim of the activity clear.

Your Australian friend, Aaron, has been using language that may be considered sexist by many people. He is not conscious of the evolution of language use and how gender-inclusive language must be incorporated into our ordinary speech.

Write a text message to your friend (about 80 words) giving him advice on how to use more inclusive language.



In written mediation, you need to interpret the content of the infographic, and be able to explain and give your opinion, if asked, in an informal or colloquial way.

Make sure you include all the aspects your friend needs to know in your message.
A text message does not have a clear structure, but it normally has one paragraph.

Let's get ready!

In this section, you will help students to get ready for the task. First of all, they will learn what to do (Analyse the task) and later, they will work on the information (Analyse the information). You can give them the Learning Sequence worksheet to work on.

1. Analyse the task

Tell students they are going to think about the receiver of the message, the reason for the message and the information included. This will help them to use the proper register (formal or informal).

Read the task carefully and say whether these statements are true (T) or False (F). They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

a) Your friend uses sexist language because he is a sexist. F

b) You are going to send him an informal e-mail. F

c) Your intention is to tell him off. F

d) You would like him to use more inclusive language. T

2. Analyse the information

Tell students to think about the relevant information on the infographic they will have to use.

Read the information in the infographic carefully.

a) Make a list of things you have to include in your text message in the first column. You can copy the words from the infographic.

b) In the second column, paraphrase the list. Use your own words to refer to the same ideas. Do not write whole sentences. Just the idea behind each thing.

Things to include	Use your own words
Definition by the European Parliament	Inclusive language definition
Keep it neutral	Ways of addressing people
Don't assume	Ask for the pronouns a person prefers
Avoid "he", "his", etc.	Strategies not to use "he", "his", etc.
Use unbiased generic words	Use words that do not include gender references
Inclusive content	Be careful with topic or word choice

Let's prepare the language!

In this section, students will learn structures and language suitable for the task.

1. A text message

1. Read the message below where a student is explaining to their mother why he / she will not be home on time. Pay attention to the following aspects:
   a) What's the style, tone and register? friendly and informal
   b) Is there a greeting and a farewell? Yes.
   c) How many paragraphs are there? one
   d) Which features of spoken language can you see in the message? contractions, subjects are missing, wanna
   e) How does the writer express feelings or emotions? with emojis and punctuation marks such as exclamations

Hi mum!!!!! I'm not coming home for lunch today. The English teacher's given us a lot of homework to do 🤯 3 people were doing maths in the English class, 2 people were playing truant and we were all speaking when she was trying to explain how to write a for and against essay. Need to do some group work with Chris & Julia and they're free at 3 so we'll stay in the canteen, eat something & do the work quickly. Wanna be home by 6. Love you 😍

2. Persuading someone to do something

Are you good at persuading people to do things?

1. These are verbs that you can use to persuade. Match the verb and its definition.

urge	Strongly recommend someone to do something.
recommend	Give a suggestion based on your opinion.
consider	To think about something.
suggest	To give a very soft recommendation for something.

2. Decide which sentences are asking or persuading someone to do something. There are 5 answers.
   a) I really don't know what to do.
   b) Why don't you give it a go?
   c) I'd really appreciate your effort in doing it.
   d) You'd really be helping me out.
   e) I don't usually do that kind of thing.
   f) I know you can do it.
   g) Come on! There's nothing to lose!
   h) OK, I'll think about it.

3. Another possible way of persuading people is to use modals verbs. Let's revise when to use "should", "ought to" and "had better".

Subject + *should* + base form verb

Subject + *shouldn't* + base form verb

They express advice.

e.g. You should go to see a dentist if you have toothache.

Subject + *ought to* + base form verb

It's stronger than "should" as it implies that you are not doing it.

e.g. You ought to be studying right now. You have an exam tomorrow. (I'm telling you this because you are not studying right now).

Subject + *had better* + base form verb

Subject + *had better not* + base form verb

It is stronger than the previous ones as it implies a warning or even a threat.

e.g. You'd better be there on time. (If not, there will be consequences.)

4. Choose the correct answer:

a) We …… call Mary. It's been ages since we last saw her.
   A. should
   B. ought to
   C. both are correct.

b) You …… park here. This is a parking for disabled people.
   A. shouldn't to
   B. shouldn't
   C. ought to

c) Mark, you …… go on the school trip if you're not feeling well.
   A. had better not
   B. ought to
   C. had better

d.) Medicine …… be free for everyone.
   A. had better
   B. shouldn't
   C. ought to

Do not use the same expressions all the time. It is important to vary the language to show you have a good vocabulary.



Let's mediate!

Make sure students understand the task and you can summarise the tips below.

Your Australian friend, Aaron, has been using language that may be considered sexist by many people. He is not conscious of the evolution of language use and how gender-inclusive language must be incorporated into our ordinary speech.

Write a text message to your friend (about 80 words) giving him advice on how to use more inclusive language

1. Content

Content

Look at the instructions and the infographics and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend. You can use the following questions:

- What is inclusive language?
- Why is it important to use inclusive language?
- Which tips can you give your friend? Be as specific as possible.

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your language (register, style) to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the useful language on page 2, 3 and 4.

Refer students to the task again and tell them to pay special attention to the Quick Tip. Make sure that the students read the rubric, so that they know what is important.

Let's evaluate!

Rubrics for assessment

Written Mediation

	Excellent	Good	Acceptable	Unsuitable
Clarity	The information is clear and easy to follow.The main points are emphasised.	The information is clear to follow but sometimes it is not easy to understand what the main points are.	The information selected is not relevant, lacks coherence and may include contradictions.	The information selected is not relevant, not clear, not easy to follow and includes contradictions.
Relevancy and processing	The student has summarised and paraphrased the main ideas without copying literally. No information has been added.	The student has summarised the main ideas but has not paraphrased them. No information has been added.	The student conveys some appropriate information by summarising the main ideas, but not all.	The student doesn't convey much appropriate information or has copied it from the text. Extra information may have been added.
Genre and organisation	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type, addressing it appropriately to the specific audience.	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type, but it is not addressed appropriately to the specific audience.	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type to a certain extent but the degree of formality is not correct.	The text does not follow the conventions of the specific text type, or it is not addressed appropriately to the specific audience.
Cohesion and organisation	The written text is logically organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs, which have a key sentence. A wide range of connectors and linkers is used.	The written text is logically organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs, which mostly have a key sentence. Basic connectors and linkers are correctly used.	The written text is organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs but they do not have key sentences. A few basic connectors and linkers are correctly used.	The written text is not logically organised. Some parts are not coherent. Paragraphs seem to have no connection. Some basic connectors and linkers are used but not all correctly.
Vocabulary	The student uses a wide rage of appropriate vocabulary. Spelling is correct.	The student mostly uses appropriate and varied vocabulary. Spelling is correct.	The student uses appropriate vocabulary but it is not varied. There are some spelling mistakes but they do not impede comprehension.	The student doesn't use varied vocabulary or is not able to paraphrase. There are many spelling mistakes.
Grammar	The student uses a wide range of correct grammatical structures.	The student uses a wide range of grammatical structures but not always correctly.	The student uses basic but correct grammatical structures.	The student uses basic grammatical structures but not always correctly.